Equip



BUILDING WELL:
Values over Behaviors

PART I: Overview of Building Well
Healthy discipleship is building well into the lives of others. Spend some time reading 1 Corinthians 3:4-17 and make note of what Paul says about: **the builder, the building,** and **the building process.**

In verses 10-15 Paul makes it clear that what we build into ourselves and others matters, because fire will test the materials. Therefore we want to be building with values, not just behaviors or knowledge.

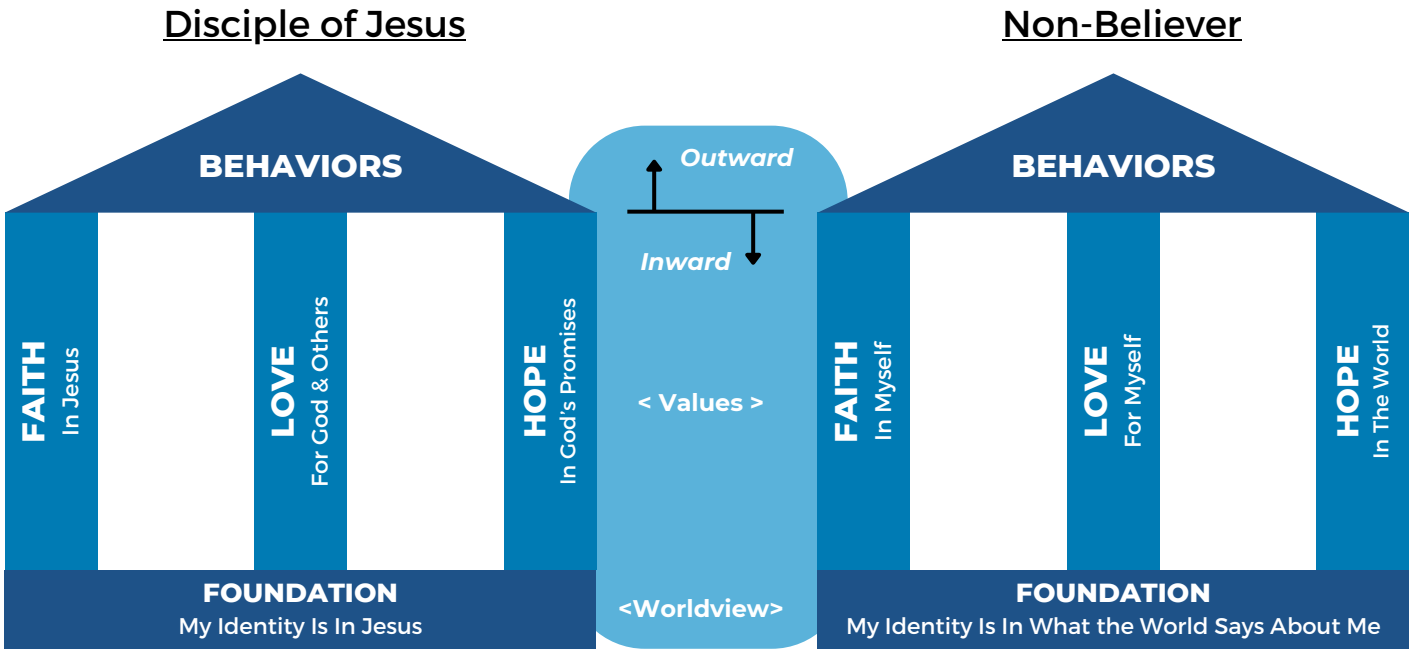
- What potential "fires" will we face in life?
- How would these two lives be different in the "fires": the one primarily built on values, and the other on behaviors and/or knowledge?

The important values repeated over and over in Paul's epistles are **faith**, **hope**, and **love**. These materials, rooted in a foundation of Jesus, are the ones that will last and that we want to be building into ourselves and others.

And now these three remain: faith, hope and love. But the greatest of these is love.
(1 Corinthians 13:13)

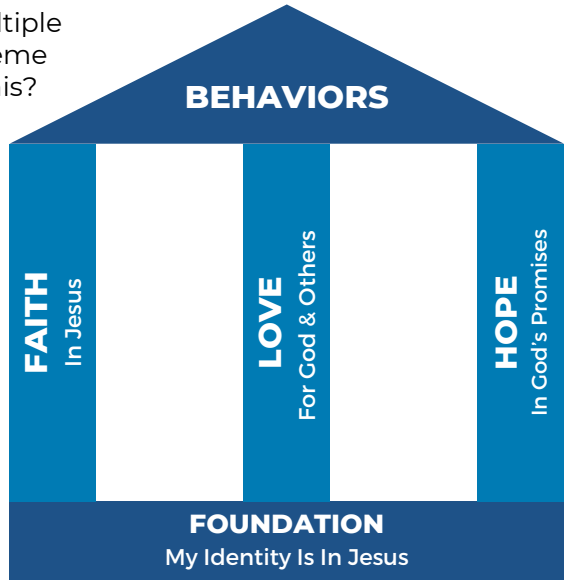
These principles are depicted by the building illustrations below, differentiating between a disciple of Jesus and a non-believer. Considering the two illustrations:

- Our Worldview (Identity) dictates our Values and our Values will dictate our Behaviors. How have you seen this to be true?
- What are the differences between the two buildings when lived out in daily life?
- Is there an area that you personally want to grow?



BUILDING WELL

Parts II-VI of this plan dive more deeply into the various elements of the building illustration. They can be done over the course of multiple meetings, but for each: (1) How does this connect to the main theme of building well? (2) How could you help someone else grow in this?



PART II: Foundation of Jesus

Read Matthew 7:24-27

- Why is it important to have a foundation on Jesus?

From John 1:1-18 and Colossians 1:13-23:

- List out the truths of Jesus
- Why is He a good foundation for our lives?
- What is our identity in light of His?

Apply: Choose a truth of Jesus that is hard to believe. Memorize and meditate on a corresponding verse, asking Jesus to help you believe it is true.

PART III: Love

Read 1 John 4:7-21:

- How is God's love described?
- How are we called to love in light of His love?

Listen to "*Love and the Practical Graces*" sermon by Timothy Keller *(can be found on YouTube.)*

- What does it look like to grow in love?

Apply: Choose one practical step to love God or someone else this week. Ask someone to join you!

PART IV: Faith

How would you define faith? List out 5-10 verses that talk about faith and read them together.

Read Hebrews 11:1-16 (Hall of Faith)

- Based on this, what marks a life of faith?

Apply: Choose a spiritual discipline you enjoy. How has it helped you grow in faith? Practice sharing it through the lens of growing in faith!

PART V: Hope

Read Romans 8:18-30

- Make observations about hope
- What are we hoping for and in?

Hebrews 6:19 calls hope "*an anchor for the soul*"

- Why is hope important? What anchors your soul?

Apply: Choose a promise of God to hope for. Is there someone else who needs to hear this too?

PART VI: Persevering in Love, Faith, and Hope

Read Hebrews 10:19-25

- What does it say about...
  - Foundation in Christ (19-22)?
  - Love (24-25)?
  - Faith (22)?
  - Hope (23)?
- Why is perseverance needed to live these out?

Summarize what you've learned in Parts I-VI in 1-3 sentences. How should this impact disciple making?

Apply: What would your life look like in 5, 10, 20 years if you persevered in each of thee areas? What is one choice you can make today to help you persevere for a lifetime?

**Optional Study: Read each of the epistles and note the uses of faith, hope, and love (highlight, box, circle, etc). Further study the passages that use all three: (1) What do you learn about each of them? (2) How do they interconnect? (3) What context are they being used in?*

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